The Culture of Business, Finance and the Economy

Class 1

March 3

Dr. Juan M. del Nido

First semester 2026

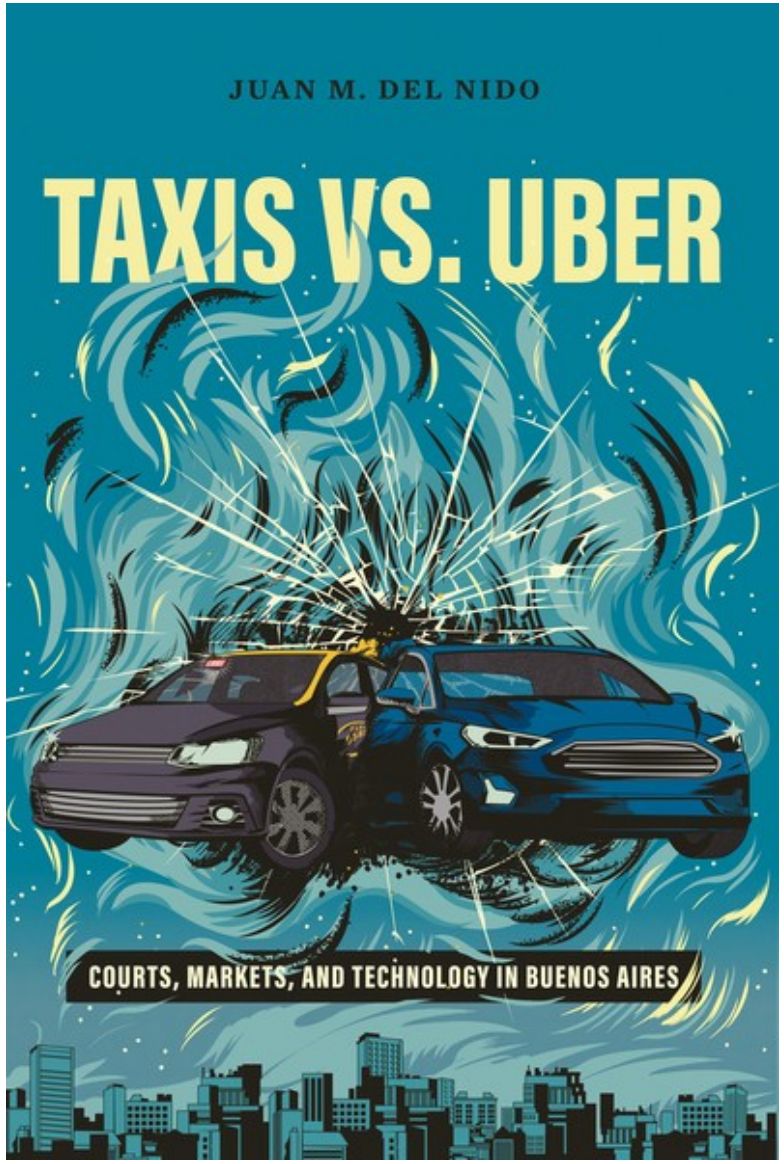
Welcome

What this course is and how it came into being

Is there a culture *of* business, *of* the economy or *of* finance? Based on case studies spanning Norwegian management consultants, Swiss investment bankers, medieval traders and Native North American shamans, this course will look at the practices, intuitions and less-examined kinds of knowledge that make business, finance and the economy function in a particular way.

We will examine questions such as: what kinds of expertise do consultants *actually* have and where does their authority come from? How do finance experts come to know the stock market - and their successes and failures in it? How do abstract notions like “efficiency” travel from economic theory to popular intuitions of how markets work? What kinds of technologies – gadgets, materials, ways of knowing – produce business, financial or economic expertise as something unique and authoritative?

Me


JUAN M. DEL NIDO
TAXIS VS. UBER
COURTS, MARKETS, AND TECHNOLOGY IN BUENOS AIRES

What we are here <u>for</u>

Examine the ways in which business, finance and the economy work, think, and make sense of things *beyond the claims these professions and disciplines make about themselves*. The aim is <u>not</u> to antagonise or "debunk" them, but rather to reflect on how certain ways of doing things stuck instead of others; on how specific ideas came to mean what they do and with what consequences; and on how certain technologies and ways of knowing can shape the things they purport to merely describe.

This way of thinking and of doing things is *in itself* a culture that requires as much learning, nurturing, reproducing and ritualising as any other culture does.

- ***Class 1: Introduction: What is "The Culture of Business, Finance, and the Economy"?***
- ***Class 2: The Superiority Of Economists: Logics And Reasons***
- ***Class 3: The Birth Of The "Spontaneous Order" And Economists As Shamans***
- ***Class 4: The Invention Of Mathematics: Beauty, Perfection And The (New) Language Of All Things***
- ***Class 5: The Mathematization Of Economic Reasoning***
- ***Class 6: Economics Copies Physics: The Science Of All Things***
- ***Class 7: Models As A Way Of Knowing And (The Difficulty Of) Thinking Beyond Models***
- ***Class 8: Thinking Like An Economist: Social Life In Economic Logics***
- ***Class 9: Numbers And Quantification: Knowing Through Numbers, Audit Cultures And The Moral Force Of Numbers***
- ***Class 10: Consultant Cultures I: The Beginnings, From Mavericks To "White Collar" Experts***
- ***Class 11: Consultant Cultures II: Their Legitimacy And The Work Of Producing Abstractions***
- ***Class 12: Consultant Cultures III: Consultant Rhetoric: Excel And PowerPoint***
- ***Class 13: Consultant Cultures IV: Profitable Uncertainty***

- ***Class 14: Financial Analysts I: Becoming A Financial Analyst And Being Right Vs. Making Sense***
- ***Class 15: Financial Analysts II: The Stories That Hold The Economy Together***
- ***Class 16: The Entrepreneurial Self I: Self-Actualisation, Self-Investment and Self-Management***
- ***Class 17: The Entrepreneurial Self II: The Self As A Business***
- ***Class 18: From Makerspaces To Venture Capitalism I: The Way Of The Start-Up***
- ***Class 19: From Makerspaces To Venture Capitalism II: Hype, Pitching, Leveraging***
- ***Class 20: Venture Capitalists***
- ***Class 21: "Values" and the Invention of "Corporate Culture"***
- ***Class 22: Corporate Social Responsibility***
- ***Class 23: Meritocracy And Entrepreneurialism In The Culture Of Business, Finance And The Economy***
- ***Class 24: The Professional Managerial Class, Technocracy And The Rule Of Experts***

Evaluation

The course will be examined through two half-term tests, both based on a set of questions circulated in advance. The tests will be graded on the following scale as per UTDT's Business School policies:

Grade	Numerical Match
A	10
A -	9
B +	8
B	7
B -	**6**
C +	5
C	4
D*	2*
F*	1*

Please note: the passing grade for this course is 6 (B-), not C as in other courses in this University. Students obtaining grades lower than 6 (B-) will be allowed to re-sit that exam once, and they are only allowed one resit per course. Resit passing grades are capped at 6 (B-). The final grade results from the linear average between the two passing grades. If the resulting number ends in .01-.49, the grade is the nearest integer below. If it ends in .50-.99, the grade is the nearest integer above.

The Exam

Handwritten date

Exam results, TCBFE 2025

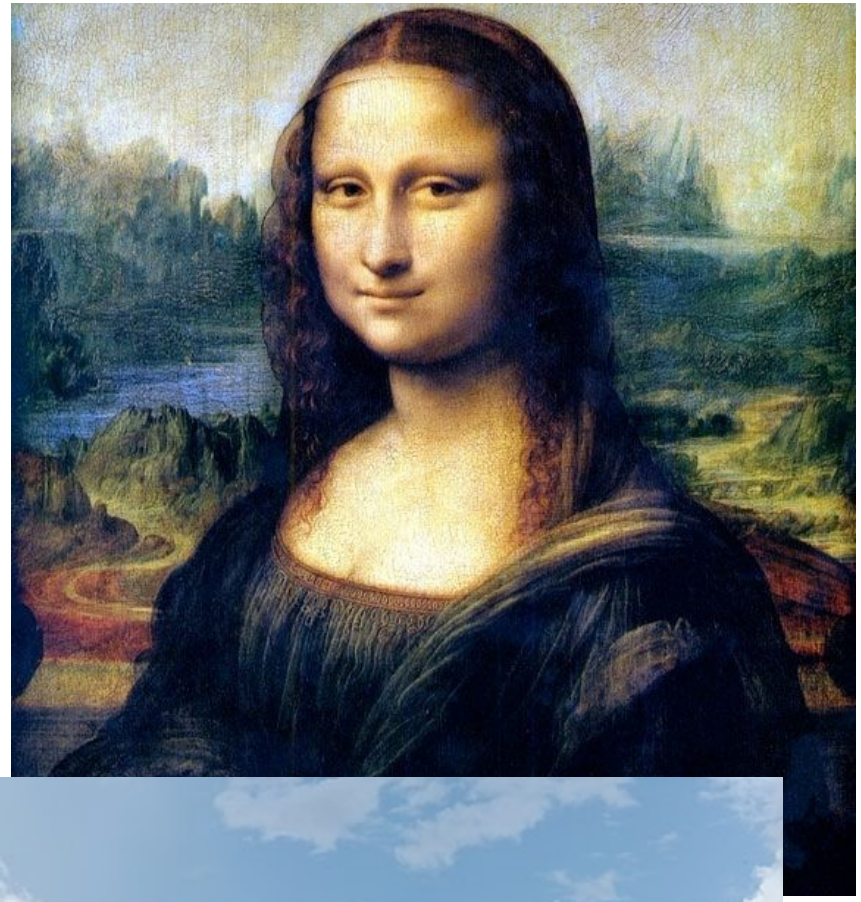
	Total	Local	Exchange
Enrolled	54	21	33
Failed	12	0	12
Fail rate	22%	0%	36%

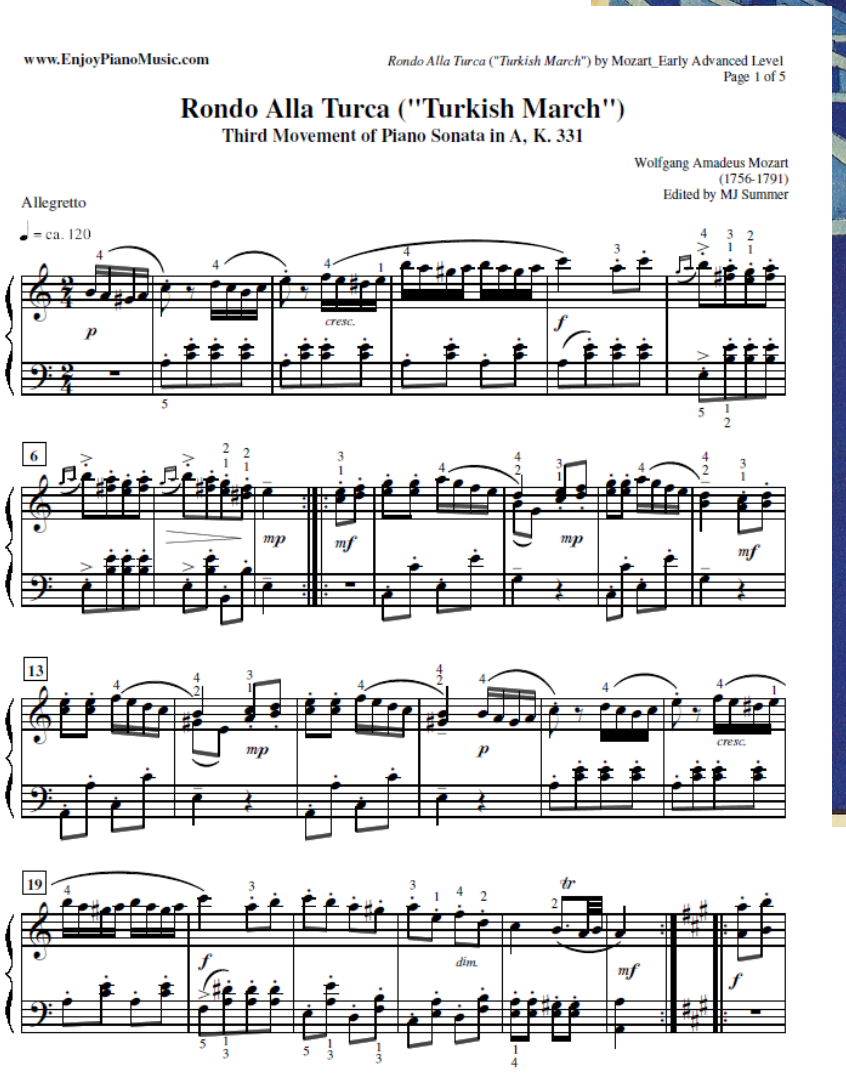
Interdisciplinary work
Class material
Class attendance (see syllabus)
“office hours”
language
How to tackle this class

Break

What is culture, or a culture?

What makes a culture, where “is” a culture?





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Rondo Alla Turca ("Turkish March") by Mozart_Early Advanced Level
Page 1 of 5

Rondo Alla Turca ("Turkish March")
Third Movement of Piano Sonata in A, K. 331

Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart
(1756-1791)
Edited by MJ Summer

Allegretto

♩ = ca. 120

p *cresc.* *f*

6 *mp* *mf* *mp* *mf*

13 *mp* *p* *cresc.*

19 *f* *dim.* *tr* *mf* *f*

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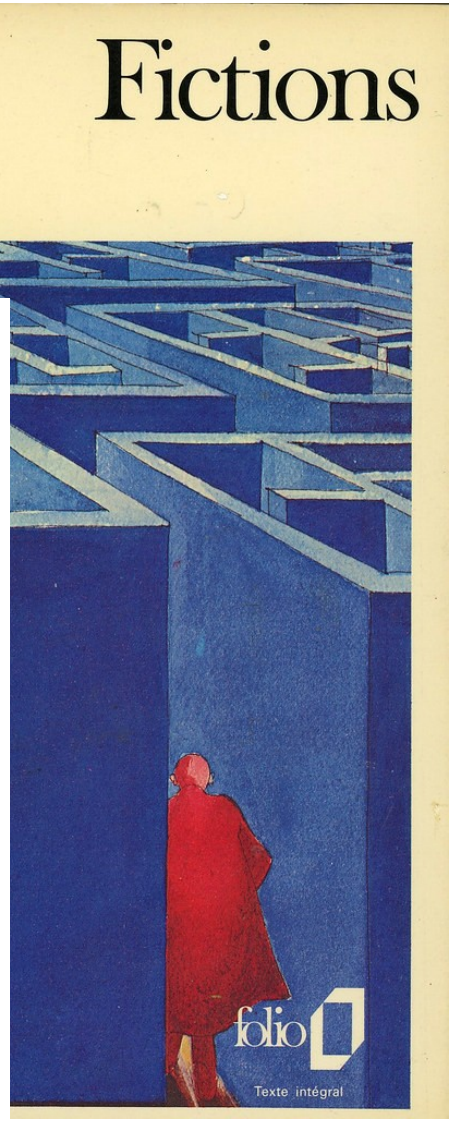

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69

Culture is a way of seeing things, a way of thinking, a way of making sense.

Culture influences how we experience things, how we think about, apprehend and make sense of complex notions like normality and deviance, the good and the bad, correctness and impropriety; how we “sort through” what matters and does not matter.

Cultures are learned and mediated by artefacts, technologies and knowledge that reproduce it, sustain it, and make it

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CONSTITUCION POLITICA
DE LA
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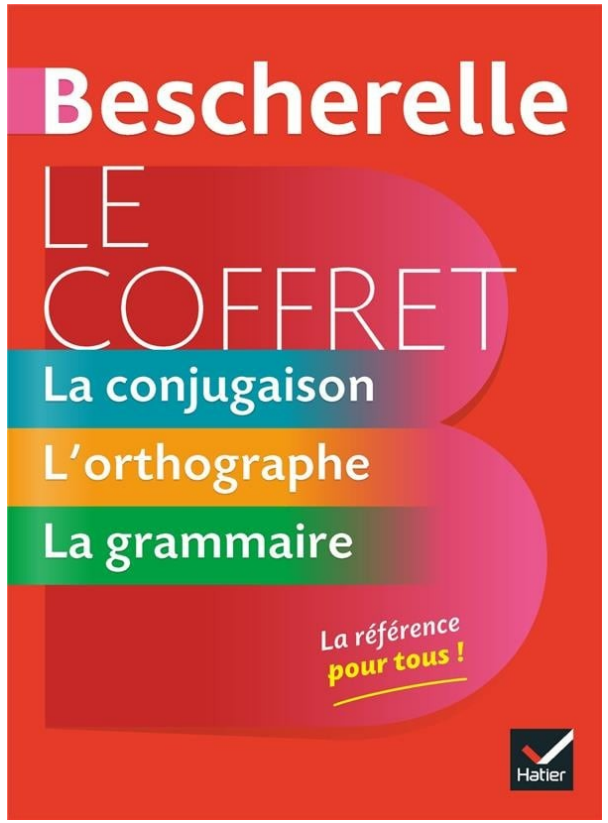
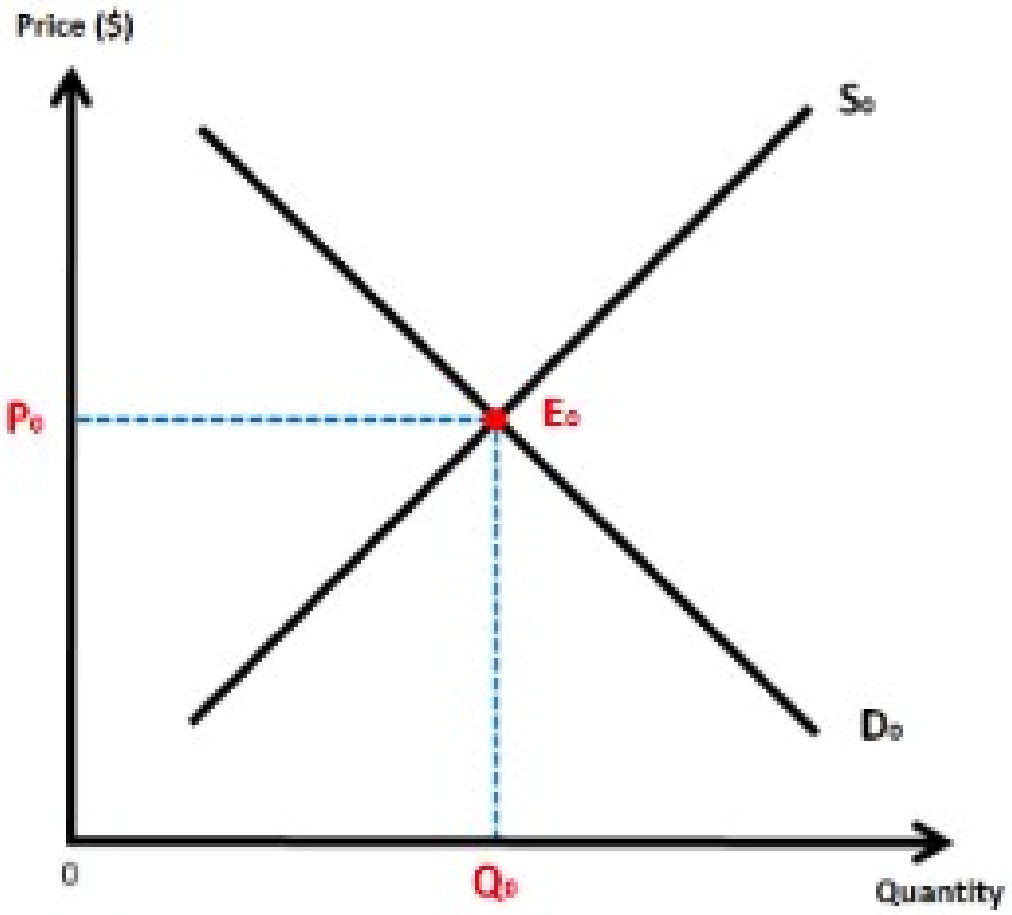

Bescherelle
LE
COFFRET
La conjugaison
L'orthographe
La grammaire
La référence
pour tous !
Hatier

amazon
basic care
For Aches & Pains
Compare to Advil
Ibuprofen
Tablets 200 mg
Pain Reliever/
Fever Reducer
(NSAID)
1000
COATED TABLETS

FORZA
OFFICIAL SIZE GAME BALL INTERLACED UPPER
TD100

PASSPORT
REPUBLIC OF INDIA

TCBFE and its technologies and ways of knowing



$$\max_{\{A_{t+1}\}_{t=0}^{\infty}} E_0 \sum_{t=0}^{\infty} \beta^t U(C_t)$$

$$s.t.$$

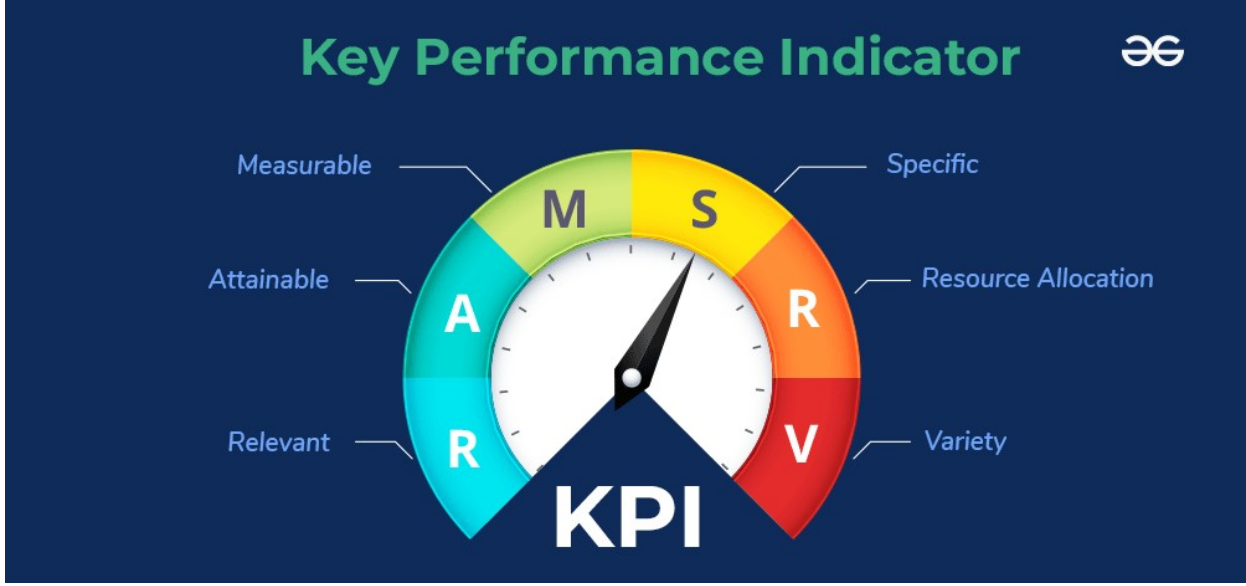
$$C_t + A_{t+1} = (1+r)A_t + Y_t$$

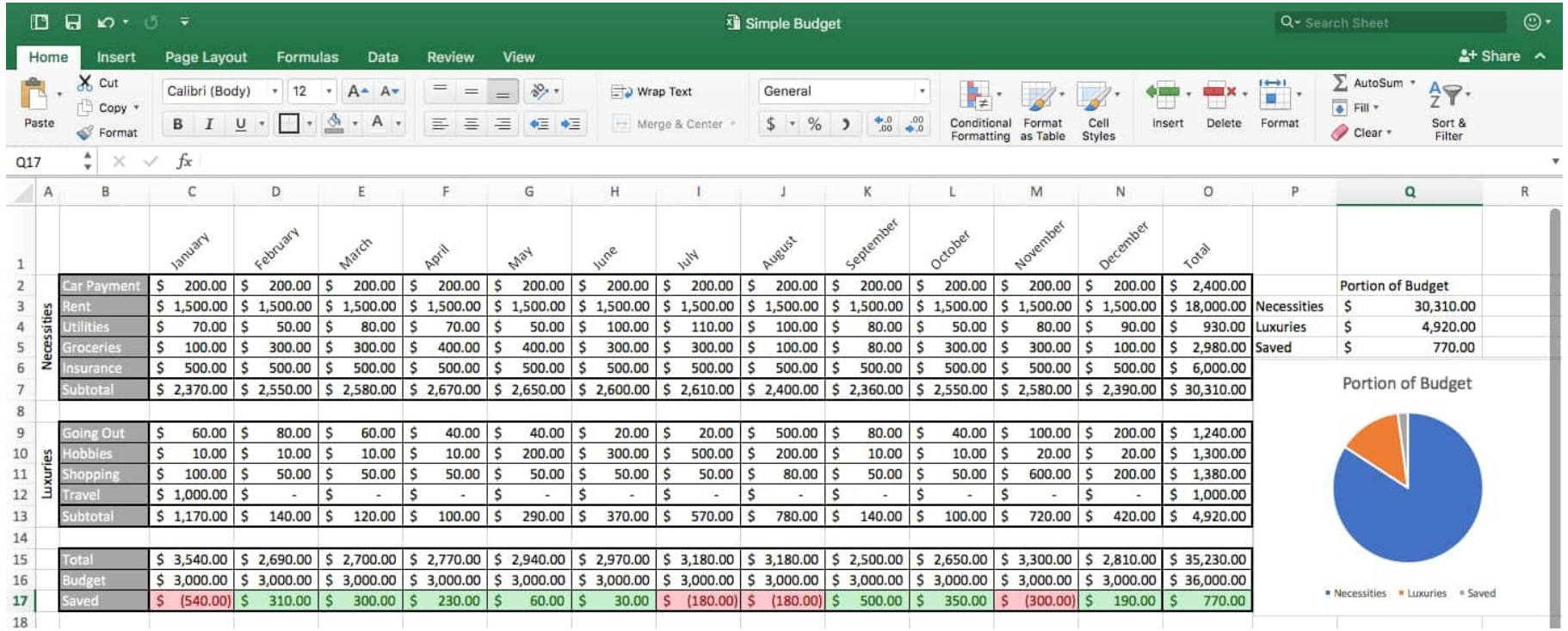
$$C_t \geq 0 \;\; \forall t$$

$$A_0 \text{ given}$$

And the Lagrangian is:

$$L \;=\; E_0 \sum_{t=0}^{\infty} \beta^t U(C_t) + \lambda_t \left[Y_t + (1+r)A_t - C_t - A_{t+1}\right]$$





		January	February	March	April	May	June	July	August	September	October	November	December	Total
Necessities	Car Payment	$ 200.00	$ 200.00	$ 200.00	$ 200.00	$ 200.00	$ 200.00	$ 200.00	$ 200.00	$ 200.00	$ 200.00	$ 200.00	$ 200.00	$ 2,400.00
	Rent	$ 1,500.00	$ 1,500.00	$ 1,500.00	$ 1,500.00	$ 1,500.00	$ 1,500.00	$ 1,500.00	$ 1,500.00	$ 1,500.00	$ 1,500.00	$ 1,500.00	$ 1,500.00	$ 18,000.00
	Utilities	$ 70.00	$ 50.00	$ 80.00	$ 70.00	$ 50.00	$ 100.00	$ 110.00	$ 100.00	$ 80.00	$ 50.00	$ 80.00	$ 90.00	$ 930.00
	Groceries	$ 100.00	$ 300.00	$ 300.00	$ 400.00	$ 400.00	$ 300.00	$ 300.00	$ 100.00	$ 80.00	$ 300.00	$ 300.00	$ 100.00	$ 2,980.00
	Insurance	$ 500.00	$ 500.00	$ 500.00	$ 500.00	$ 500.00	$ 500.00	$ 500.00	$ 500.00	$ 500.00	$ 500.00	$ 500.00	$ 500.00	$ 6,000.00
	Subtotal	$ 2,370.00	$ 2,550.00	$ 2,580.00	$ 2,670.00	$ 2,650.00	$ 2,600.00	$ 2,610.00	$ 2,400.00	$ 2,360.00	$ 2,550.00	$ 2,580.00	$ 2,390.00	$ 30,310.00
Luxuries	Going Out	$ 60.00	$ 80.00	$ 60.00	$ 40.00	$ 40.00	$ 20.00	$ 20.00	$ 500.00	$ 80.00	$ 40.00	$ 100.00	$ 200.00	$ 1,240.00
	Hobbies	$ 10.00	$ 10.00	$ 10.00	$ 10.00	$ 200.00	$ 300.00	$ 500.00	$ 200.00	$ 10.00	$ 10.00	$ 20.00	$ 20.00	$ 1,300.00
	Shopping	$ 100.00	$ 50.00	$ 50.00	$ 50.00	$ 50.00	$ 50.00	$ 50.00	$ 80.00	$ 50.00	$ 50.00	$ 600.00	$ 200.00	$ 1,380.00
	Travel	$ 1,000.00	$ -	$ -	$ -	$ -	$ -	$ -	$ -	$ -	$ -	$ -	$ -	$ 1,000.00
	Subtotal	$ 1,170.00	$ 140.00	$ 120.00	$ 100.00	$ 290.00	$ 370.00	$ 570.00	$ 780.00	$ 140.00	$ 100.00	$ 720.00	$ 420.00	$ 4,920.00
	Total	$ 3,540.00	$ 2,690.00	$ 2,700.00	$ 2,770.00	$ 2,940.00	$ 2,970.00	$ 3,180.00	$ 3,180.00	$ 2,500.00	$ 2,650.00	$ 3,300.00	$ 2,810.00	$ 35,230.00
	Budget	$ 3,000.00	$ 3,000.00	$ 3,000.00	$ 3,000.00	$ 3,000.00	$ 3,000.00	$ 3,000.00	$ 3,000.00	$ 3,000.00	$ 3,000.00	$ 3,000.00	$ 3,000.00	$ 36,000.00
	Saved	$ (540.00)	$ 310.00	$ 300.00	$ 230.00	$ 60.00	$ 30.00	$ (180.00)	$ (180.00)	$ 500.00	$ 350.00	$ (300.00)	$ 190.00	$ 770.00

Portion of Budget	
Necessities	$ 30,310.00
Luxuries	$ 4,920.00
Saved	$ 770.00

DAY — 12 SEAT NUMBER 2 4 9 7 7 5

2018 | III | 09 | 1100 | J - 309 | (E)

ECONOMICS (49)

Time : 3 Hrs. (4 Pages) Max. Marks : 80

Note : *(1) All questions are compulsory.*
(2) Draw neat tables / diagrams wherever necessary.
(3) Figures to the right indicate full marks.
(4) Write answers to all main questions on new pages.

Q. 1. **(A)** Fill in the blanks using proper alternatives given in the brackets : **[16]** (5)

(1) The terms 'micro' and 'macro' economics were first used by _____.
(Adam Smith / Robbins / Ragner Frisch / Prof. Marshall)

(2) _____ consumption can not be zero.
(Induced / Autonomous / Government / Private)

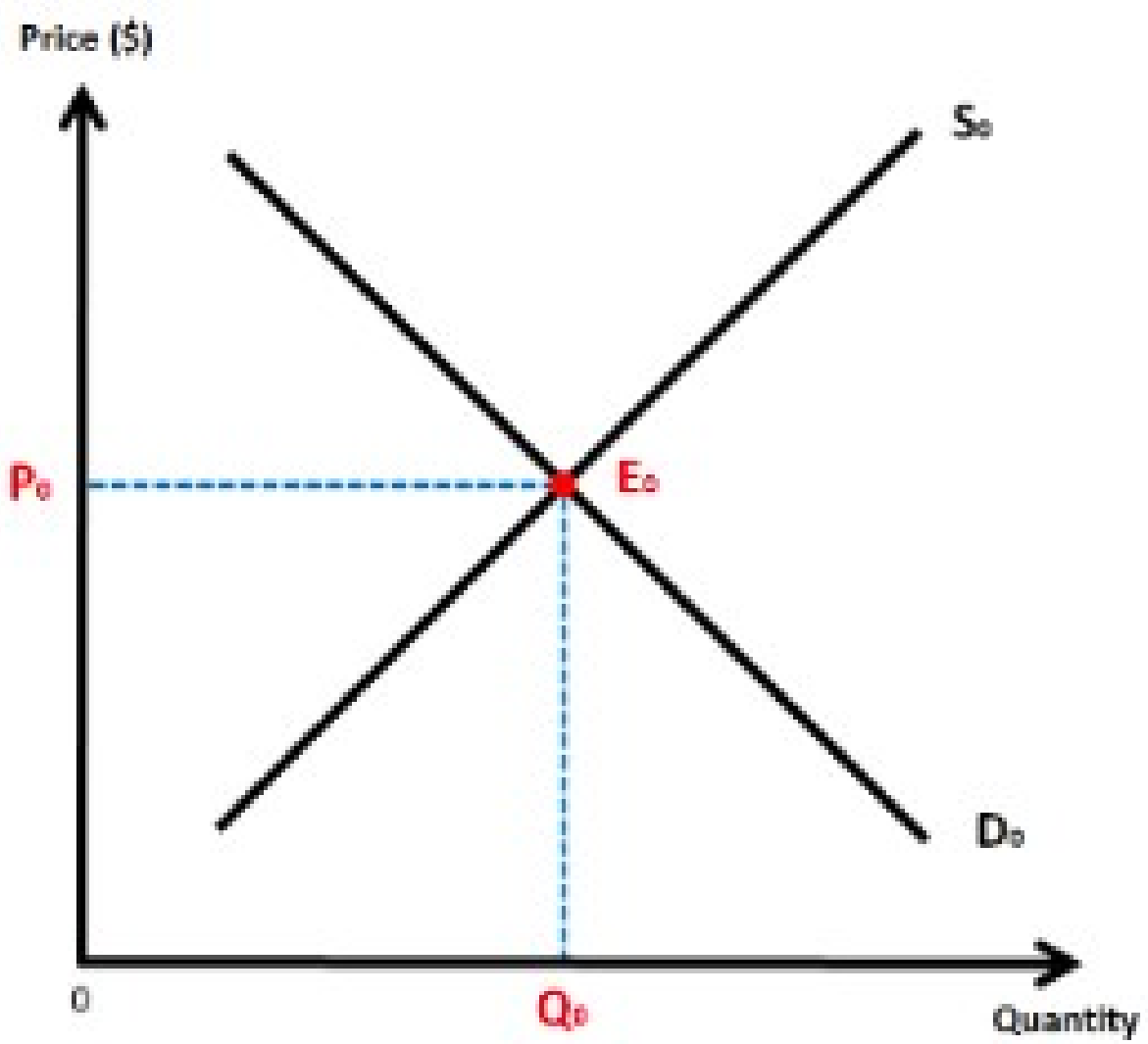
(3) During depression _____ budget is preferable.
(balanced / surplus / deficit / zero)

(4) The demand for salt is _____.
(elastic / inelastic / infinite elastic / unitary elastic)

0 3 0 0

All of these technologies, artefacts and ways of knowing create a way of making sense of the world; of ordering the things we encounter; of deciding what matters and what not, when, and for what; of persuading ourselves and trying to persuade others; of generating a common sense and an intuition.

Examining TCBFE from outside…



…Requires us generating such a thing as an “outside” from which to make sense of it to understand how “a bunch of lines” becomes a commonsensical proposition about the workings of our world

Mathematics, Physics, models, numbers, morality…

Interdisciplinary work
Class material
Class attendance (see syllabus)
“office hours”
language
Difficulty
How to tackle this class

The point of this class

Questions?